

Dear River hiring team,

Ten years in, I still like owning a problem tip-to-tail - the interface, the service, the database, the pipeline that sends it. That's the shape of your Staff opening. I've been building that way my entire career as a software and data engineer, most recently running data engineering at Pharmacists Mutual. The Bitcoin angle of your posting is what got me reading first (somewhat selfishly - I have a recurring buy set up daily on Coinbase, and watch the daily shift like a hawk). But your stack and the level are what kept me reading.

At Pharmacists Mutual I rebuilt our enterprise reporting platform from scratch: cut storage 50%, cut processing time over 60%, done as the sole technical decision-maker reporting straight to company leadership. I also built the security framework that got agentic coding tools cleared for prod, hired and onboarded a senior engineer, and have spent the last year turning our undocumented, single-owner federal/state reporting systems into ones any team-member can pick up. That last part is bread and butter for a Staff role, setting a bar and making sure other people can (and do) hit it.

Outside work I stay sharp by building solo, full-modern-stack projects: a Node/Express and React writing tool with a tree service handling recursive traversal and delete; a canvas-render-loop screensaver site with dynamically generated music, and a FastAPI/Postgres backend; a Dagster pipeline running the same dbt code against DuckDB and Postgres. None of it is Elixir yet. The fundamentals carry over though: web, database, prod reliability. I've picked up new languages fast in the past - I love learning, I've always loved it, and I know that would carry over into your role as a Staff SE.

I'd welcome the chance to talk about how I could contribute to River Financial.

All the best,
Sander VanWilligen